SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 20

Web-to-Lead in Salesforce

Automatically Capture Leads from Your Website — End-to-End Setup Guide

- 🌐 What is Web-to-Lead?
- ⚙️ How the Workflow Operates
- 🛠️ Setup & Form Generation
- 💻 Website Form Integration
- 🛡️ Google reCAPTCHA Protection
- ⚠️ Limits & Best Practices

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL
20 of Series	~19 Minutes	Beginner to Intermediate

KEY TAKEAWAY

Automate Lead Capture

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:50

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In earlier episodes, we explored the complete Sales Process and saw how Leads can be created manually inside Salesforce by sales reps.

However, in real-world business scenarios, sales teams shouldn't spend time manually typing in customer details from external inquiries. Instead, when a customer visits a corporate website and requests a consultation or product demo, that information should **flow directly into Salesforce automatically**. This feature is called **Web-to-Lead**.

SECTION 2

What is Web-to-Lead & Why Do We Need It?

⏱ 0:50 – 4:00

💻 **REAL-WORLD ANALOGY: WEBSITE CONTACT FORM**

Whenever you visit a SaaS website, college portal, or agency and fill in a *"Contact Us"* or *"Request a Demo"* form with your Name, Email, Phone, and Company, that submit button directly delivers a fresh record into their CRM within seconds.

📌 **DEFINITION**

Web-to-Lead is an out-of-the-box Salesforce feature that automatically creates Lead records whenever visitors submit an inquiry form hosted on your company website.

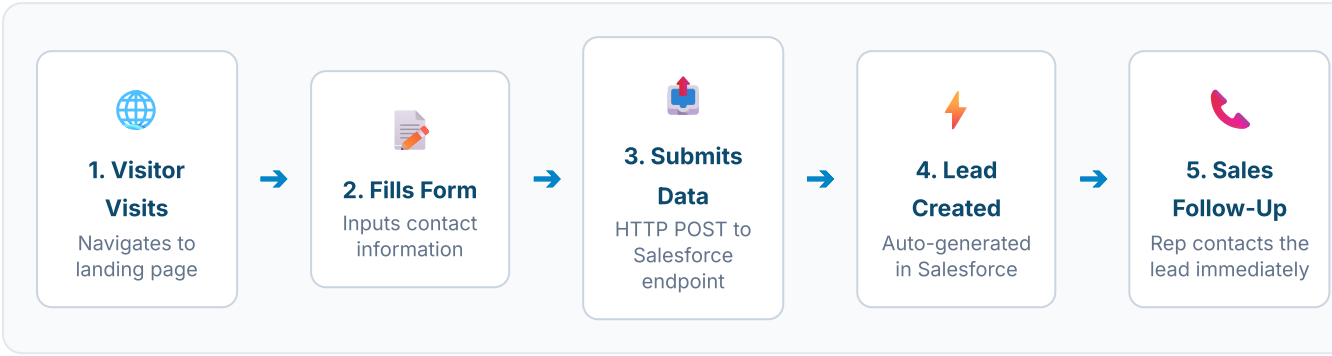
⚖️ Manual Lead Creation vs. Web-to-Lead

Aspect	❌ Without Web-to-Lead (Manual)	✅ With Web-to-Lead (Automated)
Speed	Delayed; relies on someone checking an inbox	Instantaneous (created within seconds)
Data Accuracy	Prone to human typos & data omissions	Captured exactly as entered by the prospect
Rep Workload	Sales reps waste valuable time doing data entry	Zero manual data entry; focus on selling
Customer Experience	Slow response times lose interested buyers	Faster follow-ups and immediate auto-responses

SECTION 3

How Web-to-Lead Works

⏱ 4:00 – 5:30



💡 **UNDER THE HOOD**

Salesforce provides a dedicated endpoint (e.g., `https://webto.salesforce.com/servlet/servlet.WebToLead?encoding=UTF-8`) which accepts form submissions via HTTP POST together with your Salesforce Organization ID (`oid`).

SECTION 4

Prerequisites Checklist

⏱ 5:30 – 6:30

- **Salesforce Org:** Developer Edition, Sandbox, or Production instance with active Lead object.
- **Admin Permissions:** System Administrator privileges to access Setup and configure Web-to-Lead settings.
- **Defined Fields:** Standard or custom Lead fields already created in Salesforce (e.g., Lead Source, Phone, City).
- **Hosting Environment:** An external website, CMS (WordPress, Webflow), or local HTML file to host and test the form.
- **Return URL (Thank You Page):** A URL to which visitors will be redirected after submitting the form.

SECTION 5 & 6 — HANDS-ON TUTORIAL

Enabling Web-to-Lead & Generating the HTML Form

⏱ 6:30 – 10:30

Part A: Enabling Web-to-Lead in Salesforce

1. Click the ⚙ **Setup** gear icon in the top right corner.
2. In the **Quick Find** box, type `Web-to-Lead` and select it.
3. Click the **Edit** button.
4. Check the box for **Web-to-Lead Enabled**.
5. (Optional) Select a **Default Lead Creator** (used when an automated process or missing owner requires an assigned user).
6. (Optional) Choose a **Default Response Template** to send automatic email replies to prospects.
7. Click **Save**.

Part B: Generating the Web-to-Lead HTML Form

1. On the Web-to-Lead Setup page, click **Create Web-to-Lead Form**.
2. Select the fields you want to capture:
   - `First Name` & `Last Name`
   - `Email` & `Phone`
   - `Company`
   - `Lead Source` (useful for tracking marketing ROI)
7. Set the **Return URL** (e.g., `https://yourcompany.com/thank-you.html`).
8. (Recommended) Enable **Include reCAPTCHA in HTML** to prevent bot spam.

9. Click **Generate**.

10. Copy the generated raw HTML code block to your clipboard.

SECTION 7

🌍 Embedding on Website & Live Testing

⏱ 10:30 – 12:30

1. Open your code editor (e.g., VS Code or Notepad) and create an `index.html` file.

2. Paste the Salesforce generated HTML code into the document.

3. Save the file and double-click to open it in Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge.

4. Fill in sample lead details (e.g., John Doe, Acme Corp, john@acme.com) and click **Submit**.

5. Notice the browser redirects to your designated **Return URL**.

6. Switch to Salesforce, navigate to the **App Launcher** → **Sales** → **Leads** tab.

7. Switch the list view to **Today's Leads** or refresh **Recently Viewed**. Verify that the new Lead record is present! 🎉

> 💡 **STYLING TIP**
>
> The generated HTML is unstyled basic HTML. Web designers can style it freely using CSS frameworks like Bootstrap or Tailwind, or embed the form inputs into an existing CMS form.

SECTION 8

Spam Prevention with Google reCAPTCHA

⏱ 12:30 – 15:30

🚨 **THE BOT PROBLEM**

Public forms are targets for malicious bots. Without verification, a simple script can submit the form 10,000 times an hour, exhausting your data storage and flooding your sales reps with garbage data.

📌 **WHAT IS RECAPTCHA?**

Google reCAPTCHA is a security service that analyzes user interactions to distinguish human visitors from automated bots before allowing form submission to process.

🛑

Blocks Spam & Bots

Stops automated scripts from polluting your database with fake contact details.

✨

Preserves Data Quality

Ensures sales reps spend time calling genuine prospective customers.

💾

Protects Storage Capacity

Prevents org record storage exhaustion from spam attacks.

🔒

Enterprise Security Standard

Mandatory best practice for any public-facing Web-to-Lead endpoint.

📝 **HOW TO SETUP RECAPTCHA API KEYS**

Register your domain at **google.com/recaptcha** to acquire a *Site Key* (public key) and a *Secret Key* (private key), then link them inside Salesforce Setup under `reCAPTCHA Verification` settings.

SECTION 9

⚠️ Limitations & Best Practices

⏱ 15:30 – 18:30

⚠️ Salesforce Web-to-Lead Limitations

- **Lead Object Only:** Cannot create Accounts, Contacts, or custom objects directly (use Web-to-Case for cases or APIs for custom records).
- **Daily Limit:** Supports up to **500 leads per 24-hour period**. Additional submissions are placed in an overflow queue and processed when capacity allows.
- **No Attachment Uploads:** Standard Web-to-Lead does not support uploading resumes, PDFs, or photos.
- **Limited Logic:** Does not support complex client-side validation natively (requires custom JS, Salesforce Flows, or Apex triggers on create).

💡 Recommended Best Practices

- **Keep Forms Short:** Every extra field reduces form completion rate. Ask only for essential initial contact details.
- **Always Implement reCAPTCHA:** Crucial to prevent junk leads and spam flooding.
- **Activate Duplicate Rules:** Ensure duplicate leads with matching email addresses are flagged or merged.
- **Use Hidden Fields for Attribution:** Include a hidden `Lead Source` field (e.g., `value="Website"`) to measure conversion channels.
- **Setup Lead Assignment Rules:** Automatically route leads to the right queue or rep based on territory or product line.
- **Use Auto-Response Rules:** Automatically send a professional confirmation email to the visitor upon submission.
- **Test End-to-End Before Launch:** Verify field mapping and confirmation pages in a staging environment.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 20

01

Web-to-Lead automates the transition from online website inquiry to actionable Lead record in Salesforce.

02

Eliminates slow manual data entry, cuts down human typing errors, and accelerates rep response time.

03

Setup is completely point-and-click: Enable feature → Select fields → Specify Return URL → Generate HTML.

04

reCAPTCHA is critical for security to protect org storage and keep sales pipelines free from bot spam.

05

Standard governor limits allow up to **500 leads/day**. High-volume enterprises utilize custom API integrations.

06

Pair Web-to-Lead with **Lead Assignment Rules** and **Auto-Response Rules** for full automation.



COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 21

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building advanced administration skills and automation in Salesforce!